

7. **Teach 'em a trade.** Anything you can teach your kids about maintenance, do it. If you don't know how to do it yourself, you can learn together. I know kids who've taught themselves basic car maintenance by watching how-to videos online—and they've saved thousands of dollars by not going to a mechanic. At the very least, your teenager should be able to change a tire and check the oil in a vehicle. One of Linda's pet peeves is when moms take their preschool daughters to get manicures and pedicures. If that kid is already getting biweekly pedicures at age five, do you know how much that's going to cost over her lifetime? And guess who your daughter thinks will pay forever—you! Instead, teach your daughter to give herself *and you* a mani-pedi. Bonus: if your kids end up getting good at changing oil or giving pedicures, they might even start a side business to rake in a little extra cash.
8. **Visit the local library.** It goes without saying that you should be checking books out rather than buying them new at the bookstore. But the library is also a great source of movie rentals—they've usually got a pretty extensive collection of DVDs. Instead of writing a check to Netflix every month or coughing up \$80 to take the whole brood to a movie theater, head to your local library instead. Bonus: you won't have to keep buying new shelves to store all your books and films.
9. **Take a dip in a public pool.** Spare yourself the cost of a country club membership and swim at a public pool instead. If you're in a mountainous area, scope out the streams and lakes nearby. Bonus: you're getting exercise and spending time with the family.
10. **Seek out “Kids Eat Free” nights.** Most restaurants offer free meals to kids on a certain night of the week (usually Mondays or Tuesdays), or they may offer special child